(in case of a binary tree, starts from the left child, and then, only when that subtree is all traversed, goes to the right one).
Other common traversals are inorder (the order is left subtree->node's key->right subtree) and postorder (left subtree -> right subtree -> node's key).

Of course, you can perform any action on the nodes, besides printing them.

And yes, you can do the same with loops:

Listing E.4 Binary tree preorder traversal, iterative version

```
function preorderIterative(node) {
  if (node === null) {
    return;
  }
  let nodeStack = [node];                                    #1
  while (nodeStack.length > 0) {
    node = nodeStack.pop();
    if (node === undefined) {
      console.log("leaf");
    } else {
      console.log(node.value);
      nodeStack.push(node.right);                            #2
      nodeStack.push(node.left);
    }
  }
}
```